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Add Machines

Summary

In Clan, machines describe all client devices from cloud VMs to bare metal laptops and are defined using Nix code inside the flake.

The creation of machines will be the same process for all kinds of devices and only later branch into specific steps.

This general guide will navigate you through the machine creation.

When finishing it, you will have prepared at least one machine that can be rolled out to a target device in the next steps.

Requirements

- Estimated time: 30min
- You have created a clan during the previous step
- You are logged in as root on your setup device
- direnv is running in your clan folder (see previous step for setup)

Creating a Machine

Navigate to your clan folder and run the following command to create a machine for our test user Jon:

```
clan machines create jon-machine
```

A dedicated folder will be created at `machines/jon-machine`. You can see the complete [list](#) of auto-loaded files in our extended documentation.

Configuring a Machine

You can edit your `clan.nix` file for additional machine features. This example demonstrates a setup with two machines and a few extra settings:

`clan.nix`

```
1 {
2     inventory.machines = {
3         jon-machine = {
4             deploy.targetHost = "root@192.168.0.2";
5             # Define tags here (optional)
6             tags = [ ];
7         };
8         sara-machine = {
9             # Define tags here (optional)
10            tags = [ ]; #
11        };
12    };
13    # Define additional nixosConfiguration here
14    # Or in /machines/jon/configuration.nix (autoloaded)
15    machines = {
16        jon-machine = { config, pkgs, ... }: {
17            users.users.root.openssh.authorizedKeys.keys = [
18                "ssh-ed25519 AAAAC3NzaC..."
19            ];
20        };
21    };
22 }
```

`inventory.machines`: Tags can be used to automatically assign services to a machine later on (don't worry, we don't need to set this now). Additional machines - like `sara-machine` in this example - will all be listed here if created via `clan machines create <name>`

`machines`: It is advised to add the `ssh` key of your setup device's root user here - That will ensure you can always login to your new machine via `ssh root@ip` from your setup device in case something goes wrong.

The option: `inventory.machines.<name>` is used to define metadata about the machine.

That includes for example `deploy.targethost` or `machineClass` or `tags`

The option: `machines.<name>` is used to add extra *nixosConfiguration* to a machine

(Optional) Manually Create a `configuration.nix` instead

- ▶ You can create the configuration file manually if you don't want to use the cli commands

(Optional) Removing a Machine

- ▶ If you need to delete a machine...

Checkpoint

Verify that your machines have been created successfully by listing them:

```
clan machines list
```

This should display all the machines you've created (e.g., `jon-machine`). If you don't see your machines listed, double-check the previous steps.

Up Next

In the next step, we will create and configure the users for the machines we just prepared.

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Add Users

Need help? Reach out to [our community](#).